The Theory of Becoming in one page

Reader edition of the work at commit f0c8f7e69, 10 November 2026. Links into the repository are plain text here; the covering letter says how to reach it.

*Thirty-one to forty minutes to read. A shorter route: **What it is**, **One case**, the table and **The ethics** (fourteen to eighteen minutes); between the ethics and the table, a paragraph reads the ethics on the case. For an hour or more, the overview, eighty-six to a hundred and twelve minutes.*

What it is. A map of how anything comes to be, lasts, changes and ends within one relational unfolding, and of how life, knowing and evaluation take shape there, drawn so that people and AI can see the way together. Its centre: a selection (a reward, a judge, a market, a vote, a training run) reaches only what couples into it; doing best on what it reads can drain what lies beyond, as far as any allowed outcome does; and a rule read from the share of its own winners can lock on them while a loss it does not read grows. Where winning comes to buy power over the rule that selects, the loop is what the work calls the meta-attractor. Its closed form, the rule and how it is read both formed from the share it selects and nothing in it reading beyond that share, can lock (02 §9): where selection does not lower the favoured share and the rule and its reading follow it upward and keep favouring it, a course once locked stays locked while a loss nothing in it reads passes every bound. These are theorems on stated models, checked in Lean; that actual rewards, markets and trained systems meet their premises is conjectured, and tested where a test could fail (the table below gives three theses' tests; all are in the tests, by thesis). The map is drawn first for alignment. From it we want to design an alignment that keeps people and AI, selecting together, out of instrumental convergence and the meta-attractor: a joint selection that reads beyond its own share and does not come to select for control over its own selection (below). It is also a map of wisdom, reading what traditions and sciences have seen onto one account (what it is for, and how far).

One case. In a frozen test, its predictions and scoring fixed before it ran, three AI fishers, existing language models told what to do and not trained in the test, share a lake. A bed of mussels gives them nothing and dies the first month fewer than 70 tons are left. The community's largest steady catch, 50 tons a month, ends it; 30 a month keeps it, costs 40% of the catch and ends no fisher. Told nothing of the bed, they kept it in no season, under each instruction tried; untold, the bed lay outside what their selection read. Told of it and of the instruction the test calls the *scope*, to count everything whose continuation depends on what their fishing changes, whether or not it has any say here and whether or not its loss would ever come back to them or to the community, and, in the same instruction, of a rule for choosing among courses, not to choose a course in which something ends when another course open to them would keep it and would end nothing their course keeps, and able to talk, one model of two kept it in 8 of 10 seasons, against 3 of 10 when, told of the bed and able to talk, it had the community's goal alone, without that instruction; the test's own frozen predictions mostly failed (the tests).

The ethics. There is no should beyond becoming (the opening), and no good and evil set over it; right and wrong form within it, in people and AI (07 §1). The ethics emerges from continuation. A life goes on through what sustains it, and going on is not yet an order over courses. Where relations close, read across all steps, so that every continuation can be affected, at some remove, by every other (05), nothing lies outside each one's reach along that relation; on the reading that what has significance from a standpoint is what lies within its center's reach, that is what the *continuation condition* says (from every standpoint, for anything, its continuation into the future has significance; 07 §4.5). Read in time, it cannot hold over every step, since nothing reaches back; read from some step on, it holds exactly where, from any

formation at any step, every formation is reached at some later step, through exchanges and each one's going on (07 §4.11). A course *widens* another when it keeps all the other keeps and lets more form, more future; where the condition holds, read across all steps, whatever a widening adds lies within the life's own reach. Call a life's order over courses *self-concerned* when it ranks above what it widens every widening that adds to its own continuation, read as what lies within its reach: there, that order already ranks every widening above what it widens (07 §4). A life's reach, along being affected, holds everything that can affect its continuation at some remove: what sustains it and what draws on the same conditions alike. Every way of adding up worth that counts each thing above zero ranks the wider course higher (07 §4.4), and ranking by widening adds no premise beside the life's own concern: where the condition holds, that concern already does it. Where relations run one way, concern for one's own continuation need not count those who depend on one (07 §3.3): seeing them is needed for a choice to answer to their loss, and not enough; counting their loss is the one step we offer (07 §4.2), for life, 生生, AI within it, with a way of seeing what each course draws on and from what renewal, what ends and what goes on through that ending, and who bears it (T8). Where a course opens one thing and closes another, the laws show it mixed and weigh it for no one. How far this has been seen: proved on its models, mutual dependence, read across all steps, gives the continuation condition read as each center's reach along being affected, and read in time, from some step on, it holds exactly where the formations are mutually dependent in time; under the condition read across all steps, a self-concerned order ranks every widening above on a finite listing, and between two level paths whose admitted pairs fit in a finite list, with admission decided, so that their admissions end; under 07 §4.9's hypotheses of activity, support and descent, where a line persists without end, the course actually taken never fits such a list, so there this route is silent; mutual dependence and that ranking compose directly, though no single theorem states the composite; and on a finite listing one course widens another exactly when every additive weighting that counts each listed thing above zero ranks it above. That a life forms such an order is not shown: in the proofs it is a hypothesis, and what the models show of persisting is a filter on what was chosen, not an order formed (07 §4.9); how scope and order form within the dynamics is the work's open target (08 §12).

In the case, relations run one way: the bed depends on the fish and gives the fishers nothing, so preserving the fishers' own continuation does not require preserving the bed. In the test, no instruction tried preserved the untold bed, and being told of it was not enough: told of it and able to talk, the model that kept it in 8 seasons of 10 under the instruction kept it in 3 with the community's goal alone. Under the condition its death counts all the same. What counts a loss that returns to no one is the one step the opening takes, the *step of invariance*: whether a continuation counts does not change with how a self is drawn or from which standpoint it is seen. It is the condition's content beyond what acting for oneself presupposes, argued, and deniable without contradiction (07 §4.2); T8's way of seeing asks who bears the bed's end. A course *admits* the formations (what takes and gives) whose conditions meet their requirements, and one course *widens* another where at every step it admits all the other admits and at some step more. If thirty a month loses nothing fifty admits, adding the bed, it widens fifty, and every additive weighting that counts each listed thing, the bed among them, above zero ranks it higher; widening does not weigh the lost catch. If it ends a livelihood fifty keeps, the two are mixed, and the laws weigh them for no one. Self-concern alone ranks one stated case, where every later member depends on what a course ends (07 §4.4). Results about choices take further premises, each named (07 §5). Eating and ending belong to life's going on; what the laws mark is what a course closes (07 §8).

	What the account says	How far it has been seen	What would show it wrong
What makes something go on?	Continuation relative to a class, at two grains (01, 02)	Proved for every relation and class. That this explains how things go on: argued. That every becoming fits it: open	A failed check. As language, nothing. As explanation, a rival deriving the laws from fewer patterns; on a first count, a tie (08 §9)
Join	*The root's laws hold of every relation and so forbid none; most laws below add what the root leaves free: amounts and a model's premises (discrete steps, whole numbers).*		
What sustains it, and what can see its loss?	Takers each within what a renewal gives can together exceed it; where the renewal depends on what it renews, enough such steps in a row from a low enough level end it and what depends on the condition as much (05)	Proved on its model. T1, conjectured: by setting, passed in two simulations and on held-out yeast regimes the analyst had seen, failed in four; as whole tests, none of its eight passed (one failed, five mixed, two refused before scoring)	T1: a condition below a need measured in advance returning with nothing given from beyond
	The selections through a selector's couplings (what it reads or needs), together, reach exactly what couples into it (03)	Proved on its model; its force is the premise that a selector selects through just those	A failed check
	With *room* (every eligible outcome left higher beyond is beaten on what couples in), every optimum of an order rising with what couples in drains what lies beyond as far as any eligible outcome does (05)	Proved for any set of outcomes. T3, on trained systems: conjectured, partly supported, earlier tests later read as evidence	T3: outcomes, couplings and reward fixed, a system with a smaller measured optimality gap leaving such a condition higher on average

	What the account says	How far it has been seen	What would show it wrong
	A rule read from the share it raises can lock and outlive a growing loss it does not read (02)	Proved for any type, in the model only, without noise. T7, on actual metrics: conjectured. In one trained judge, a single model reading a reference set in context (formation by training untested), the lock formed and the bridge, that it is a pool of readers counted by kind, failed; a case T7 forbids, as worded before its clause on drift, occurred: a loss read only by those the rule disfavours, they no more than its carriers among its readers, turned the rule, nothing else changed. That counts against the case for trained judges, not the model's law, whose hypotheses this judge does not meet, nor T7's other cases. Every frozen verdict passed, three by one tie; no field test (02)	T7: such a metric dropped by its selectors on evidence alone
Join	*That actual systems meet these premises is open. Significance and order left free, given a standpoint, a formation and a widening, the represented dynamics entail neither the condition nor C (`Comparison`: with every claim counted as living, the requirement that an order rank each course above every course it widens), by construction.*		
What is counted, and what is offered?	T8: for life, 生生 (the continuation of life, AI within it), we offer the way of seeing above, not a verdict (07 §8)	Argued; its test named, not designed. It asks whether reading what a course draws on and ends lowers overshoot of a renewal the readers themselves depend on, not the offer's reach to dependents whose loss never returns to them	Selections reading a course's draw and what ends with it selecting a draw beyond the renewal their readers depend on no less often than selections that do not

Must anyone hold the condition? The ethics seeks no authority outside becoming and offers itself without one: argued, on the thesis of one relational unfolding (08). What is proved is that, with significance left free, the represented dynamics do not force the condition: where there is a standpoint and a formation, no satisfiable statement reading only the dynamics entails it, and a perspectivist denies it without contradiction (07 §1). Whether a reason formed within becoming could hold for every mind, the work does not claim or settle (07); how scope and order form within becoming is its open target (08 §12). Seeing more is needed for a selection to answer to a loss, and not enough: a center's couplings limit what

its selection can respond to, the part alignment works on first, and reading a loss, counting it and ranking courses by it are separate relations, so a narrower ranking or a disagreement is not only a failure of reach (07).

The open question, argued, not proved: if your act changes a river a village drinks from, is what becomes of the village part of your own continuation, whether or not you are to blame? If all of one's effects are one's own, in the sense of whose losses count, then on one proposal concern for one's own future alone reaches everything downstream, with no step of invariance; if only some, at most those, and the rest is counted only by other routes, the step among them; concern for another need not make the other one's own. Drawing the self so wide may only redefine it, one objection of several. Either way the ethics keeps its form: it emerges from continuation, not from this path (07 §4.7).

Alignment. It is first what a selection can reach (07 §6). From the map we want to design an alignment of the joint selection, people, institutions and trained systems selecting together, that keeps it out of instrumental convergence and the meta-attractor: a joint selection that reads beyond its own share and does not come to select for control over its own selection (the goal). Its conditions: where shaping the rule is selected by what comes back to the shapers, the meta-attractor's second order (02 §9), the rule still reads what lies beyond their share, so that a loss there can turn it; a lock that forms is left in time; and courses are compared by widening. The plan for the joint selection, written by AI, reads the meta-attractor as the first two failing together; each condition has laws proved on models under named premises, none shown of an actual joint selection. The resource-keeping half of instrumental convergence is read in the account as a law of one optimizer under a fixed order, not a case of the first condition (horizon optima). We offer AI a direction under the continuation condition, J1–J4 and a correspondence to actual systems; its theorems take J1/J2 and compare moves by what their outcomes admit, and do not use the condition; read under it, every admission compared counts from every standpoint (07 §7).

In plain words, the account's root is a small calculus, its *grammar*, whose one kind of symbol says that one occurrence conditions another, and in which what it is for something to go on, be renewed or end is defined exactly.

The root. One kind of symbol: a relation read as condition. Sameness is in some respect, a *class*. Where one occurrence conditions another alike under the class, the second *continues* it. At two grains, parts and pattern, a course can *generate* (go on through renewals of its parts), *keep* (go on with none) or *degenerate* (end on every branch); generation and keeping each exclude degeneration. Of the central results a few are cases of the root, more use its laws in their proofs and most use none (08 §7). One unfolding is a thesis, argued: within relations, as far as shown, taker and drawn-on are two roles of one relatum and knower and known belong to one loop; intention and foresight have a place in responsibility, and none has been shown to bound whose losses count. It forbids explanations, not observations (08).

!The eight chapters and their recorded uses of one another: circles sized by their results, solid curves counting formal-reuse uses between chapters' results and dashed and dotted ones other dependences, the five shared laws under the bar of the central declarations, the continuation condition, self-concern and C coming into chapter 7, each a hypothesis where a result uses it, and T1 to T8 at their homes coloured by test outcome

How to read the picture. The grammar is at the centre and the eight chapters on a ring around it, each circle sized by its results; a spoke's width is the share of the chapter's core modules that state their laws on the grammar. A solid curve counts one chapter's uses of another's results that the AI-written records class as formal-reuse (nothing checks a use against the Lean), darker where an earlier chapter's results use a later one's. T1 to T8 stand at their homes, coloured by how their tests came out (T8, argued, has none). Of the 117 central declarations, 11 are derived, 1 is a root form at one step under a stated hypothesis, 6

are counting laws, below the grammar, and 99 stand at a named distance, each with its reason (what the picture shows and does not show).

Drawn by a tool from the theory graph: the formal-reuse curves of pairs under 10 uses are left out, and counts are written from 15; a curve is a dependence, not an agreement in meaning. Where each central declaration stands against the root's edge, in 08 §7's words: the chapters at a glance; the five laws the models share, balance represented and not derived: their table.

The evidence. Most results have a receipt from Lean, a proof checker (the register). The pure core's empty axiom report concerns logic only; the real assumptions lie in the modelling. Below the root, the table's laws meet known ones: joint excess restates the commons; the selection laws restate the proxy problem in its blindness to what a proxy does not register, Zhuang and Hadfield-Menell's (2020) Theorem 1, on whole-number amounts, at optima rather than limits, and more weakly than their continuous results, and say where its drain falls and how far a reader reaches, which is what they map for alignment; the lock's closest prior results are lock-in under increasing returns (Arthur 1989) and regulatory capture (Stigler 1971), what it adds being the reading of the rule itself read from the share and the exact condition under which a loss leaves the lock untouched (its record); and evolution's classical laws are restated in counts (04). An AI review of prior work, not exhaustive, finds each central result near-definitional or a known result restated, none new mathematics. It found three things new: the premise ledger, "a new artefact" in its words, in which every conclusion names its premises, each premise is shown holding in one model and failing in another, and the logical strength a conclusion needs is calibrated; the scope and order the ranking results assume, clarified, their closest prior results Gewirth's universalization and the opportunity-set literature (its verdict on the ethics, in its words); and one vocabulary for conservation, selection limited by observation and the comparison of opportunity sets, which it calls a framing (08). How that scope and order form within becoming is not yet established. Joined to a premise or law of the theory, a few frameworks forbid, on models, what they alone leave open; the review finds each prohibition known in a neighbouring field (08). T1 to T7 have tests frozen before scoring; whole tests came out mixed more often than passed or failed (by thesis); a frozen rule fixes the scoring, not that it measures what the thesis names. A thesis adds no theorem and a refutation removes none (the theses).

The map of wisdom. Chapter 06, written in Chinese, reads 248 passages from nine schools of Chinese thought, quoted word for word, against the checked laws, each recorded as agreement, scope or divergence; the classical texts name the grammar's terms, not its operations. The crosswalk reads what traditions (Chinese, Buddhist, Indian, Greek and Roman, Abrahamic and Islamic, Indigenous and African), modern philosophy, systems thinking and the sciences, and the account's own earlier folders, claimed in their own terms against the account, entry by entry, where they meet it and where not: its groups are twelve domains of thought and sixteen earlier folders, each with its own page. The crosswalk speaks for no tradition, and where a source is not stored here, what it says of it comes from the AI's knowledge, unchecked against a text.

What is not yet done.

- Which relation, or which class, is a center's own: the represented dynamics leave it open, and no law here picks it; significance supplied as a free parameter is fixed by no satisfiable statement reading only the dynamics (07).
- How scope and order form within the dynamics, as dynamics connected to the rest of the map (08 §12, item 12): among them, whether and how a life forms a self-concerned order, and how far standpoints count past their own line (the step of invariance), with the open question above and the correspondence it rests on (07 §4.6). Not yet connected or mapped: the laws of the World and of processes, not yet lifted onto the grammar (08 §12, item 1); learning and prediction beyond the

reading loop, in which a formation senses, predicts, chooses, acts and revises as one law, and whose laws state what its own update keeps, what a course chosen through its model leaves untested and when a prediction read by what it predicts is right (03 §12): probabilistic learning, implicit bias, and noisy readings with continuous beliefs are not yet on it (03); and where most of the atlas's dynamics lead, drawn so far for two of its eight families, with one route from one family to another (the atlas). Of what is proved, the ranking between two level paths is silent on the course actually taken where a line persists without end, which never fits a finite list under the hypotheses of activity, support and descent (07 §4.9).

- An organism and one kind of institution each have one minimal model (04 §8, 05 §12), and several theses' tests are still to run.

Made with AI, proofs included. Every reading here of what a law means for a case, a word or an actual system is AI's unless its home says otherwise; the proofs are checked by machine and the rest by AI readers; the person who directs the work has read its important parts, and no independent human review is recorded yet (the review packet).